

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4
♥ J 9 5
♦ K 10 7 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ K Q J
♥ A 8 6 2
♦ Q 6 3
♣ 10 9 4



♠ 7 2
♥ Q 10 4 3
♦ A J 9 2
♣ Q 7 3

♠ 10 9 8 6 5 3
♥ K 7
♦ 8 4
♣ A K J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Don't think of passing. With 11 HCP and 2 length points you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You must bid and you want to show that you have a bare minimum. You don't want to say 2NT because of that doubleton nothing ♦. So you rebid your 6-card ♠ suit. Partner bids 4 ♠ and everybody passes.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. East wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have already lost the 2 ♦ s and you sure can't escape losing the Ace of trumps. So you mustnot lose a ♣ trick. So your Plan will be to pull trumps, then finesse East for the ♣ Q.

You ruff the third ♦, play ♠ s until the ♠ A appears. When you regain the lead you pull any outstanding trumps, play one high ♣, (in case someone has a singleton ♣ Q), then enter dummy with the ♥ A and make the ♣ finesse. Half of the time you make the contract, the other half you don't.

You were lucky that the ♣ Q was with East.

It's never great when the success of your contract depends on a finesse, but sometimes that's your only hope - a 50% chance.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 5 2
♥ J 10 9 8 2
♦ K 4
♣ 9 8

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ K Q 7 6

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W		E
	S	

♠ A 7

♥ K 6 5 3

♦ 7 6 2

♣ 10 5 4 3

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ A J 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT	Pass	1NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

lose the lead. That means the ♦ finesse had better work. At trick 2 you lead your ♦ Q, playing low from dummy if West doesn't cover. Repeat the finesse as necessary. When West has the ♦ K you will make your contract, and when East has the ♦ K you will go down. That's a 50% chance, just like most finesses. But remember, if you had tried to establish the ♠ suit instead of taking the finesse your chance of making 3NT would be 0%.

You can see what could have happened if you had tried to sneak even one ♠ trick. East would have grabbed the ♠ A and played a small ♥. West would have happily taken 4 ♥ tricks and you would be down 1.

You have a very solid 17 points and a balanced hand. You open 1NT. Partner responds 3NT and you pass.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥ J. You hopefully put on the ♥ Q, but East plays the ♥ K.

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Winners: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 4 : Total = 6

A hold-up won't help unless East had a doubleton ♥, giving West a 7-card suit. So you win your ♥ A. The ♠ suit is solid after the ♠ A is played, but before you could enjoy those 3 tricks the defenders would have really enjoyed a bunch of ♥s.

Your only hope is to win 8 more tricks before you